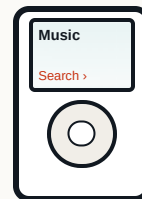


iPod Video 5.0 vs 5.5

Identify the right revision, avoid a dying hard drive, and know your walk-away price before you meet the seller.



DO NOT TRUST
"Model A1136" alone

FASTEST 5.5 PROOF
Music menu has Search

CAPACITY SHORTCUT
60GB = 5.0 • 80GB = 5.5

01 / IDENTIFY IT

The back says A1136 on both revisions

PROOF POINT	5.0 (2005)	5.5 ENHANCED (LATE 2006)
Music menu	No Search	Search present
Original capacity	30GB or 60GB	30GB or 80GB
30GB order no.	MA002 (white) MA146 (black)	MA444 (white) MA446 (black)
Large order no.	MA003 / MA147 60GB	MA448 / MA450 80GB
Display	Original brightness	Brighter display

30GB is the trap. It exists in both revisions. Ask for a photo of **Settings** → **About** plus the Music menu showing Search. A replacement back can carry the wrong engraving, so compare the on-screen serial with the back.

02 / TEST IT

Seven checks before money changes hands

- ☐ Cold boot: no sad-iPod icon, loops, or long hangs
- ☐ Click wheel and every button respond cleanly
- ☐ Both headphone channels play without crackle
- ☐ USB connection charges and appears on a computer
- ☐ Play, seek, pause, and shuffle several tracks
- ☐ LCD has no pressure blotch, lines, or dead zones
- ☐ Battery percentage does not collapse in 10 minutes

Best extra test: open diagnostic mode and inspect **IO** → **HardDrive** → **HDSMARTData**. Pending sectors, rising reallocations, restore failures, or audible clicking mean "price as a drive replacement," not "working."

03 / PRICE IT

Practical buyer targets in CAD

Untested / parts / failed drive	C\$40–80
Working 5.0, stock 30/60GB	C\$90–140
Working 5.5, stock 30GB	C\$120–170
Working 5.5, stock 80GB	C\$150–200

Pay above the band only for proof: clean SMART data, strong battery, completed sync/restore, exceptional cosmetics, box/accessories, or documented flash/battery work.

These are WantWatcher negotiation targets, not appraisals. September 2026 public asks for working 30GB units are C\$150–220; dealer-refurbished 5.5 variants are about US\$173–216 (roughly C\$244–305 at 1.41 CAD/USD) before shipping.

04 / WALK AWAY

Red flags that erase the "5.5 premium"

- A1136 is offered as "proof" of 5.5, but Search and the order number stay hidden.
- Back and About-screen serials do not match: the case may be swapped.
- Black pressure mark on the LCD, lifted faceplate, or a bulging seam: possible swollen battery.
- The drive clicks, freezes, fails to restore, or shows pending/reallocated sectors.
- "Fresh battery" or "flash mod" with no parts list, capacity proof, or working sync test.

COPY / PASTE TO SELLER

Ask for proof, not promises

"Could you send photos of Settings → About and the Music menu, plus a short video of a cold boot and a song playing? Please confirm the serial on About matches the back, the battery holds charge, both headphone channels work, and it connects/syncs by USB."

Stop refreshing Marketplace.

Get an alert when the right iPod hits your price.

wantwatcher.com